

CA PES MONTHLY BRIEF

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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC
& EURASIA



CONSORTIUM FOR
ASIA PACIFIC &
EURASIAN STUDIES



CA PES proudly announces the launch of

KOREA-PAKISTAN EDUCATION CORRIDOR (KPEC)

Scan to register:



A series of opportunities to promote student
exchanges between Pakistan and Korea



ISLAMABAD
JUNE 8-11, 2026

KOREA-PAKISTAN EDUCATION CORRIDOR

CA PES is proud to launch the Korea-Pakistan Education Corridor, aiming to facilitate educational and student exchanges between Pakistan and the Republic of Korea. The KPEC shall comprise a series of events and activities to highlight the potential of student exchanges and materialize the existing potential into durable partnerships. Under the purview of KPEC, CA PES shall be organizing the KPEC Expo in Islamabad as the first significant step in facilitating student exchange between both countries.



CA PES SIGNS MOU WITH UNIVERSITY OF OKARA

CA PES has signed an MoU with the University of Okara to strengthen academic and research collaboration. This partnership aims to create opportunities for researchers and students to engage in critical dialogue and joint research initiatives. The MoU was signed by Dr. Ekaterina Gavrishyk, Director of External Linkages, University of Okara, and Dr. Gul-i-Ayesha Bhatti, Director of the Eurasia Chapter, CA PES.

MEETING WITH DR. MARIA HEBISZ

CA PES hosted Dr. Maria Eleonora Hebisz from the University of Lodz, Poland, where the two sides discussed avenues for deeper cooperation. The engagement reflected a shared commitment to fostering international collaboration and enhancing educational and research linkages between Pakistan and Poland.



KOREA-PAKISTAN EDUCATION CORRIDOR (KPEC)



CAPES held a plenary meeting of faculty and representatives of ORIC departments of public and private universities as part of the Korea Pakistan Education Corridor (KPEC). The meeting focused on discussing concrete proposals for establishing strong ties between HEIs of Pakistan and South Korea.



A delegation from CAPES met with the Principal and Senior Faculty at SMME, NUST to discuss KPEC and prospects of cooperation between the visiting Korean universities and SMME, NUST. Both sides exchanged ideas to ensure optimal outcomes from the KPEC and decided to continue cooperation on the project.

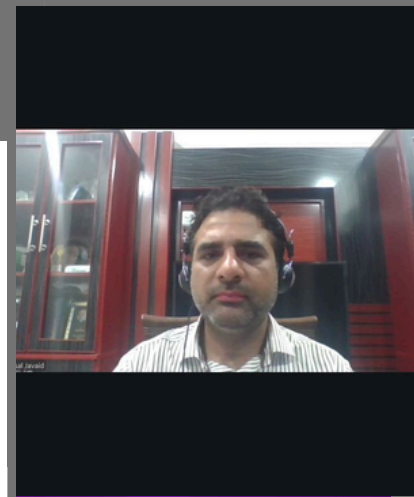


PRESIDENT CAPES TALK AT INSTITUTE OF POLICY STUDIES (IPS)

Dr. Khuram Iqbal, President CAPES, participated in the discussion hosted by the Institute of Policy Studies (IPS), analysing the US-Iran ceasefire agreement. He highlighted how developments between the US and Iran are likely to influence regional security architectures, diplomatic alignments, and the strategic calculations of major and middle powers alike.

SVP CAPES TALK AT PITZER COLLEGE, UNITED STATES

Senior Vice President CAPES, Dr. Faisal Javaid, delivered a distinguished guest lecture at Pitzer College in the US, where he addressed students, faculty members, and researchers on the evolving geopolitical dynamics between Iran and the United States, as well as Pakistan's emerging diplomatic and strategic role in the region.



PRESIDENT CAPES PARTICIPATES IN SPUTNIK NEWS WEBINAR

President CAPES, Dr. Khuram Iqbal, spoke at the international webinar organized by Sputnik News on the topic, "The New Axis of Trade: Where do the Key Logistics Routes Run Today?" The webinar discussed the rapidly evolving global trade landscape and the emergence of new connectivity corridors reshaping international commerce.

CAPES PARTICIPATES IN CISS SEMINAR ON INDIAN STRATEGIC CULTURE

CAPES General Secretary and Director North-East Asia Chapter, Dr. Umair Parvez spoke at the National Seminar on Indian Strategic Culture organized by the Center for International Strategic Studies (CISS). Dr. Parvez discussed the Sources of Indian Strategic Culture and Grand Strategic Thought.





Rethinking Pakistan-Korea relationship

**PRESIDENT CAPES DR. KHURAM IQBAL
& DIRECTOR NORTH EAST ASIA CHAPTER
DR. UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR THE KOREA POST**

<https://www.koreapost.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=48047>

“Pakistan–Korea (Republic of Korea/South Korea) relations have steadily expanded over the years. Trade, investment, and development cooperation form a strong foundation. Korean companies such as Samsung, Hyundai, KEPCO, and Daewoo have made lasting contributions to Pakistan’s industry, energy sector, and infrastructure. Yet, beyond trade and investment, the real untapped potential lies in human capital and education. For decades, students from South Asia looked primarily to Western destinations—drawn by open campuses, strong research cultures, and established diaspora networks. That landscape is now changing. As the global centre of gravity shifts from West to East, educational mobility is shifting as well.”

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**Islamabad talks: Pakistan,
backed by China, leads
US-Iran peace**

**DIRECTOR N.E. ASIA CHAPTER
DR. UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR
DAILY SABAH**

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/islamabad-talks-pakistan-backed-by-china-leads-usiran-peace>

“It has been more than a month since the so-called operation “Epic Fury” was started by the U.S. and Israel against Iran. Since then, Iran has been bombed numerous times, and its leadership has been decapitated, including Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei. In all this chaos, Pakistan has emerged as a key peace broker and mediator in the conflict. The parties have shown trust in Pakistan, and it has emerged as a key player in the regional and global politics.”

Europe’s Energy Crunch

**DIRECTOR EURASIA CHAPTER
DR. GUL-I-AYESHA BHATTI
WRITES FOR
THE PAKISTAN OBSERVER**

<https://pakobserver.net/europes-energy-crunch/>



“For Europe, conflict in the Middle East is never a distant spectacle. It reaches the continent through shipping lanes, commodity markets and household budgets long before it appears in diplomatic communiqués. US-Iran war has once again reminded European states that their prosperity remains tied to events unfolding thousands of miles away. At the centre of the anxiety lies the Strait of Hormuz, one of the world’s most critical energy arteries.”

Rivalry without return

**CA PES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR,
WRITES FOR THE NEWS**

<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1408907-rivalry-without-return>



“For 79 years, Pakistan and India have remained locked in a dynamic that has proven remarkably resistant to change. Political cycles, security crises, and hardened narratives have reinforced a status quo in which hostility persists, engagement remains limited and meaningful progress remains out of reach. That dynamic may have been tolerable in a different era, but it is no longer sustainable.”

**INTERNATIONAL
THE NEWS**

Order without legitimacy

**CA PES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR,
WRITES FOR THE NEWS**

<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1411574-order-without-legitimacy>

“When a person walks into a police station to register an FIR, the first calculation they make is not whether the officer behind the desk can help them, but what it will take to be helped: a phone call, an introduction or the quiet understanding that something must change hands. The law assumes every citizen enters it on equal footing, but experience teaches otherwise.”



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Cambodian authorities agree to the early repatriation of 54 Pakistanis.
- The Ambassador of Pakistan to Thailand and the Thai Foreign Minister discussed convening a restructured Joint Commission at the ministerial level in Bangkok this year.
- Pakistan's High Commissioner to Indonesia highlighted Islamabad's commitment to strengthening relations with Timor-Leste in the economy, health, and defence.
- The Embassy of Pakistan in Hanoi officially welcomed the newly elected leadership in Vietnam.
- President Asif Ali Zardari visited China to bolster the "full spectrum" of bilateral ties.
- Pakistan and Thailand agreed to enhance academic collaboration through STEM scholarships.
- Pakistan's Ambassador to Indonesia participated in the Middle Powers Strategic Dialogue in Jakarta to discuss middle power agency amid rapid global geostrategic shifts.
- Pakistan's High Commissioner to New Zealand discussed a new public health and genomics collaboration with the New Zealand Institute of Public Health.
- The Ambassador of Pakistan to Thailand and the Thai Foreign Minister discussed convening a restructured Joint Commission at the ministerial level in Bangkok this year.
- The Pakistan Pavilion was inaugurated at Japan IT Week 2026 with a focus on expanding IT exports.
- Australia and Pakistan enhance cooperation against human trafficking with a national dialogue in Islamabad.



PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- FM Ishaq Dar held talks with Russian FM Sergey Lavrov to reschedule PM Shehbaz Sharif's planned visit to Russia.
- Pakistan begins exports to Kyrgyzstan through the Sost border.
- Pakistan's Ambassador to Russia, Syed Faisal Niaz Tirmizi, met with Russian Orthodox Church Representatives.
- Kyrgyzstan's FM Jeenbek Kulubaev and Pakistan's FM Ishaq Dar held a telephone conversation.
- Pakistan invited Shanghai Cooperation Organisation member states to hold the next SCO health ministers' meeting in Islamabad .
- Kazakhstan's Ambassador to Pakistan, Yerzhan Kistafin, undertook a two-day visit to Lahore.
- Pakistan gets approval to export fish and potatoes to Russia.
- Pakistan has advanced plans to revive and expand Pakistan Steel Mills after signing a third protocol with a Russian private company.
- Kazakhstan, Pakistan elevate bilateral trade target to USD 1bn.
- Russian Envoy visits historical landmarks in Sindh.
- Defence Minister Khawaja Asif held meetings with his counterparts from Iran, China, Kazakhstan and Tajikistan on the sidelines of the SCO Defence Ministers' Meeting in Kyrgyzstan.
- Denis Nevzorov, Trade Representative of Russia, stated that Russia will extend full support to enhance bilateral trade with Pakistan.